



One-Piece Octopus

By Virginia Rogers

Five Monkeys Menagerie

<https://fivemonkeysmenagerie.wordpress.com/>

Copyright information

This pattern and all pictures included are property of Virginia Rogers. No part of this pattern may be rewritten and sold as your own pattern. The photos may not be reproduced without my permission. The pattern may be shared, but please provide a link back to this blog. Finished products may be sold anywhere, but please give me credit as the designer and provide my blog address.

I am available to help if you run into any problems with a pattern. I would love to hear how you liked the pattern and see pictures of your finished project. Thanks!

Notes

Can be made in any size yarn. Use a hook which allows you to crochet tightly enough that the fiberfill will not poke through the holes. Crocheted in the round in one piece. Do not join rounds, just keep working into the next stitch. You can work decreases as regular sc2tog or single crochet invisible decreases. To do the latter: insert hook into front loops only of next 2 stitches, yarn over, pull through 2 loops on hook, yarn over, pull through final 2 loops on hook.

Materials

Bernat Softee Chunky Yarn in any color. You can get several octopuses from one skein.

I hook

12mm safety eyes (cat eyes are good)

Yarn needle for sewing in ends

A small amount of fiberfill

Rattle (optional)

Skills and Terms Used

Magic circle (if you don't know this, check youtube, there are several good instructional videos)

Sc: single crochet

2sc: make 2sc in the next stitch

Sl st: slip stitch

Ch: chain

Sc2tog: single crochet 2 stitched together, or so invisible single crochet decrease

Front loop only single crochet (again, check youtube if you need instructions)

Octopus

1. Sc 6 in a magic circle, pull tight (6 sts)
2. 2sc in each st (12)
3. (sc, 2sc) six times (18)
4. Sc in each st (18)
5. Sc in each st (18)
6. Sc in each st (18)
7. Sc in each st (18)
8. Sc in each st (18)
9. (sc, sc2tog) six times (12)
10. (sc, sc2tog) four times (8) completing the “head” portion (mantle) of the octopus



11. Working in front loop only for this round only, 2sc in each st (16)
12. Sc in each st around (16) (note ring of back loops inside octopus, right photo)



13. Working in both loops, sc in next st, ch10, turn, in 2nd ch from the hook, sc, sc in the 8 remaining chains. Sc into the next st from round 11. One tentacle completed.



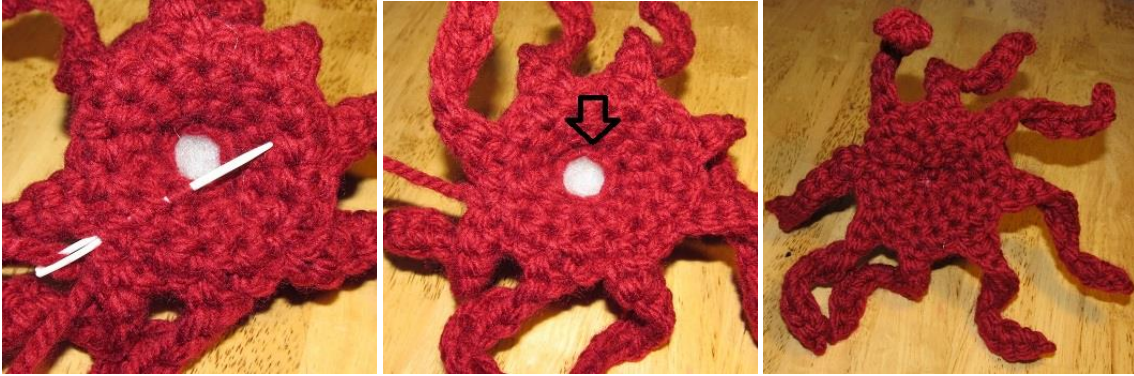
14. Repeat step #12 seven (7) more times for a total of 8 tentacles **if you are feeling creative, see tentacle variations at the end of the directions**
15. Sl st into the base of the first tentacle, end, leave a tail for sewing body closed.



16. Place eyes between rows 8 and 9 or 9 and 10, 3-5 sts apart. Closer spacing and higher eyes give a cuter octopus, wider spacing and lower eyes gives a more realistic octopus. Yellow cat eyes are the most realistic (see the blue octopus in the cover photo and at the end) but my 2 year old was calling the design shots this time and wanted red eyes for his red octopus. He likes red.
17. Stuff the body (and put in a rattle if desired), but don't stuff the "neck" area. If you stuff firmly, the head will be upright and cuter. If you stuff more loosely, you can tilt the head down to the back for a more realistic look.



18. Using the yarn needle, run the tail of yarn to the center underside of the octopus (left photo below)
19. Using the back loops (the little ring indicated by the arrow in the center photo below), sew the opening closed.
20. Sew in the end and enjoy your octopus!



Tentacle variations

It looks nice if the octopus's tentacles have some variety to them. Here are three basic ways to change the curliness of the tentacles. I used a combination of these styles for my red octopus. See photo below

Mostly Straight: chain 10, turn, starting in 2nd ch from the hook, sc 9 back along the chain

A Little Curlier: chain 9, turn, starting in 2nd ch from the hook, (sc, 2sc) four times back along the chain

Curliest: ch8, turn, starting in 2nd ch from the hook, sc, 2sc in the remaining 6 chains

The number of chains varies to make the tentacles appear the same length. You can also do any combination of sc, 2sc, and maybe even 3sc, when you are working back along the chain. Get creative.

